

SAP HANA & S/4HANA

Migration, Architecture & New Features Guide

5+ Years Experience | ECC & S/4HANA

For Experienced MM/ECC Professionals Transitioning to S/4HANA

1. SAP HANA DATABASE FUNDAMENTALS

What is SAP HANA?

SAP HANA (High-performance ANalytic Appliance) is an in-memory, column-oriented, relational database management system. It serves as both a database and an application platform.

Core HANA Concepts

Concept	Description
In-Memory	All active data stored in RAM - eliminates disk I/O for reads
Columnar Storage	Data stored by column (not row) - ideal for analytics/aggregations
Row Store	Certain operational tables stored row-wise for fast single-record access
Compression	Column store allows 5-10x data compression
MVCC	Multi-Version Concurrency Control - readers don't block writers
Delta Merge	Writes go to row-based delta store, then merged into column store

HANA Architecture Layers

Applications (ABAP, Java, HTML5)
?
Index Server (SQL Engine, Calc Engine, Graph Engine)
?
Persistence Layer (Log Volume + Data Volume)
?
Physical Disks (for persistence/restart only)

Column Store vs Row Store

Column Store	Row Store	
Best for	Analytical queries, aggregations	Transactional, single-record updates
Compression	Very high	Low
Query speed	Fast for few columns, many rows	Fast for all columns of one row
Examples in HANA	Most HANA tables	Session management tables

Key Interview Questions

Q: Why is SAP HANA faster than traditional RDBMS for analytical queries?

A: Column storage means only the columns needed for a query are read from memory - not entire rows. This dramatically reduces data volume scanned. Combined with in-memory operation (no disk I/O), data compression (less memory bandwidth), and SIMD CPU instructions for column operations, HANA delivers orders-of-magnitude faster analytics. The elimination of aggregate tables (like totals tables in ECC) also simplifies the data model.

Q: What is the Delta Merge in HANA and why does it exist?

A: Write operations go to a row-based delta store for fast insert/update performance. Periodically, HANA merges the delta store into the main column store (delta merge). This allows both fast writes (row-optimized) and fast reads (column-optimized). The merge can be triggered manually or automatically based on size thresholds.

2. S/4HANA vs ECC - KEY DIFFERENCES

Architecture Shift

Aspect	ECC	S/4HANA
Database	Any RDBMS	HANA only
Data Model	Complex (aggregate tables, totals tables)	Simplified (aggregate tables eliminated)
UI	SAP GUI / Web Dynpro	Fiori (primary) + SAP GUI (compatibility)
Vendor/Customer	Separate vendor master / customer master	Business Partner (unified)
Material Ledger	Optional	Mandatory
Currency	Up to 2 parallel currencies easily	Up to 10 parallel currencies
MRP	Classic MRP	MRP Live (embedded in HANA)
Reporting	BW aggregates / extractors	Embedded Analytics / CDS views

Simplified Data Model - Key Examples

ECC Tables	S/4HANA Replacement
BKPF + BSEG + BSIS + BSAS + BSID...	ACDOCA (Universal Journal)
AUFK + COEP + COSP + COSS	ACDOCA
MARA + MARC + MARD + MBEW	Simplified, MATDOC replaces MSEG
Customer Master (KNA1+KNB1...)	BP (Business Partner)
Vendor Master (LFA1+LFB1...)	BP (Business Partner)

Deployment Options

Type	Description
S/4HANA Cloud (Public)	Fully managed, standard processes only, quarterly updates
S/4HANA Cloud (Private)	Hosted by SAP, customer-specific config, less flexibility than on-prem
S/4HANA On-Premise	Customer-hosted, full flexibility, annual release cycle
S/4HANA Rise	Commercial offering bundling cloud infrastructure + S/4HANA

Key Interview Questions

Q: What is the biggest structural change in S/4HANA compared to ECC from an MM perspective?

A: Several fundamental changes: (1) Business Partner replaces separate vendor/customer masters - using BP transaction instead of XK01/MK01; (2) Material Ledger is mandatory - all materials must use actual costing; (3) MRP Live runs directly on HANA for near-real-time planning; (4) Inventory management uses MATDOC document table replacing the complex MSEG/MKPF structure; (5) GR/IR clearing is handled differently in the simplified accounting model.

Q: Can you still use SAP GUI transactions in S/4HANA?

A: Yes, SAP GUI (backend) transactions are largely still available for backward compatibility. However, SAP's strategic direction is Fiori. Some old transactions may be blocked or deprecated in newer S/4HANA releases. New functionality is typically Fiori-only. SAP recommends adopting Fiori for new user onboarding.

3. BUSINESS PARTNER (BP)

Why Business Partner?

In ECC, customers (KNA1, KNB1) and vendors (LFA1, LFB1, LFM1) were completely separate master records - even for the same real-world entity. BP unifies them under a single master record.

BP Roles in Purchasing Context

BP Role	Description	TCode (old)
BP (General)	Basic partner data	-
FLVN00	Vendor (Purchasing Org data)	MK01
FLVN01	FI Vendor (Company Code data)	XK01
FLCU00	Customer (Sales Area data)	VD01
FLCU01	FI Customer (Company Code data)	XD01

BP Categories

- * Person: Individual person (HR-related)
- * Organization: Legal entity (companies, organizations)
- * Group: Group of persons

Migration from Vendor to BP

During ECC -> S/4HANA migration, the FSCM_BP (Business Partner Migration) program synchronizes existing vendors to Business Partners. Old vendor transactions (XK01, MK01) work via SAP-delivered compatibility mode during transition.

Configuring BP for Procurement

1. Create Number Range for BP
2. Define BP Grouping (controls number range and screen layout)
3. Assign BP roles to grouping
4. Activate CVI (Customer-Vendor Integration) synchronization
5. Configure account groups to BP groupings mapping

Key Interview Questions

Q: In S/4HANA, if a user tries to use MK01 to create a vendor, what happens?

A: In S/4HANA, MK01 routes to the BP transaction via compatibility coding. The user may see the old UI but a BP is created in the background. However, SAP strongly recommends using transaction BP directly. In some S/4HANA releases, MK01 may be fully deprecated. For Fiori, the "Create Supplier" (Manage Business Partner) app is used.

Q: What is CVI (Customer-Vendor Integration)?

A: CVI is a synchronization mechanism that keeps the BP data and legacy customer/vendor master data in sync. When a BP is created/changed, CVI automatically updates the corresponding vendor master (LFA1/LFB1) tables and vice versa. This allows compatibility with ABAP programs that still read LFA1/LFB1 while the master data is managed via BP.

4. FIORI APPS FOR MM

Fiori App Types

Type	Description	Examples
Transactional	Replace single MM transactions	Create Purchase Order
Analytical	KPIs, charts, dashboards	Purchase Order Value per Vendor
Fact Sheet	Display object details (search-driven)	Material Details, Supplier Overview

Key Fiori Apps for MM

Procurement:

App Name
Create Purchase Order
Manage Purchase Order
My Purchase Order
Approve Purchase Order
Manage Supplier
Release Supplier

Inventory:

App Name
Post Goods Receipt
Stock Overview
Monitor Inventory
Create Physical Inventory

Master Data:

App Name
Manage Business Partner
Maintain Material
Manage Purchase Order

Fiori Launchpad

* Entry point for all Fiori apps

- * Tiles organized in groups
- * Personalization: Users can add/remove tiles, create their own groups
- * Role-based: Tiles visible based on authorization role (business catalog)

Fiori Architecture

Browser (HTML5)
?
Fiori Frontend Server (Gateway + ABAP)
?
OData Service (backend data provider)
?
S/4HANA Backend (application logic)

Key Interview Questions

Q: What is the difference between an OData service and a classic ABAP program?

A: An OData (Open Data Protocol) service exposes business data as RESTful web services (CRUD operations via HTTP). Fiori apps consume OData services - the Fiori frontend (HTML5/UI5) sends HTTP GET/POST/PATCH/DELETE requests to OData services, which then execute ABAP logic on the backend. Classic ABAP programs run entirely on the server and serve SAP GUI. OData enables the decoupling of UI from backend.

Q: How does the tile count (badge) on a Fiori tile work?

A: The badge/count on a Fiori tile is provided by an OData service returning an annotation called UI.Badge. The Launchpad calls the count endpoint periodically (or on page load) and displays the result on the tile. For example, "Purchase Orders to Approve" tile shows the number of POs pending the user's release.

5. MRP LIVE (S/4HANA)

Classic MRP vs MRP Live

Aspect	Classic MRP (ECC)	MRP Live (S/4HANA)
Execution	Sequential, material-by-material	Parallel, multi-material
Location	ABAP layer	HANA procedures
Speed	Hours for large runs	Minutes (10-100x faster)
Lock behavior	Locks all planning records	Fine-grained locking
Transaction	MD01, MDBT	MD01N, MDBT (with HANA engine)
BOM explosion	In ABAP	In HANA
Availability	ECC 6.0 EhP7+	S/4HANA

Enabling MRP Live

- 1. Activate switch PLMD_MRP in SFW5 (Business Function: Embedded MRP)
- 2. Ensure materials use MRP type compatible with HANA MRP
- 3. Run via MD01N or MDBT with "MRP Live" indicator

Key Benefits of MRP Live

- * Planning runs during business hours without major performance impact
- * Real-time re-planning after demand changes
- * Responsive planning horizon (shorter planning cycles possible)
- * Detailed exception monitoring in Fiori

Key Interview Questions

Q: How does MRP Live improve on Classic MRP?

A: MRP Live executes planning directly in HANA using native procedures (not ABAP). It processes materials in parallel rather than sequentially, reducing a 4-hour MRP run to under 15 minutes for large plants. It also allows finer-grained locking so other users can work during MRP. The planning logic is the same as classic MRP - results are identical, only the execution engine changes.

6. MATERIAL LEDGER IN S/4HANA

Why Mandatory?

In ECC, Material Ledger (ML) was optional. In S/4HANA, it is mandatory because:

- * The simplified accounting model (ACDOCA) requires ML for inventory valuation
- * ML provides multi-currency inventory valuation
- * Actual costing (optional within ML) allows product cost actuals

Material Ledger Concepts

Concept	Description
ML Document	Records all value movements for a material in a period
Preliminary Valuation	Value at standard price during the period
Actual Price	Calculated at period close via actual costing run
Price Difference	Variance between standard and actual, allocated at period end
Alternative Valuation Run	CKMLCPAVR - calculate actual cost for parallel ledgers

Actual Costing Run (CKMLCP)

Steps in sequence:

1. Opening of new period: MMPV (open new posting period for MM)
2. Single-level price determination: Calculate actual cost from procurement
3. Multi-level price determination: Propagate cost differences up BOM
4. Close: Finalize and post differences

Material Ledger Documents

- * Created for every inventory movement
- * Link accounting documents with material valuation
- * Visible via MR51 (Material Ledger Documents per Material)

Key Interview Questions

Q: What is the purpose of the Actual Costing Run in S/4HANA?

A: The Actual Costing Run (CKMLCP) calculates the actual cost of materials at period end. During the period, materials are valued at standard price. Differences (price variances from procurement, exchange rate differences) are collected in the ML. At period close, CKMLCP distributes these differences to all consuming cost objects, providing actual product cost - essential for accurate profitability analysis and inventory valuation.

Q: What happens if Material Ledger is not configured correctly during S/4HANA go-live?

A: Incorrect ML configuration can cause posting errors for all goods movements. Key requirements: ML must be activated in valuation area, all materials must be set up with the correct valuation variant, the ML document type must be defined. Missing or incorrect setup leads to posting failures (error M7 021 or similar). A cutover plan must include ML balance migration from ECC.

7. CENTRAL PURCHASING IN S/4HANA

SAP Central Procurement

S/4HANA introduced Central Purchasing to manage procurement across multiple backend systems from a single hub:

- * Central Purchase Contracts visible across all connected systems
- * Central purchasing analytics
- * Manage supplier catalog centrally

Two-System Landscapes

- * Hub System: S/4HANA acting as central procurement hub
- * Spoke Systems: Backend ECC or S/4HANA systems where actual transactions run

Key Interview Questions

Q: What is the difference between a Hub-Spoke procurement model and a standalone S/4HANA?

A: Standalone S/4HANA manages procurement within a single system. Hub-Spoke (Central Procurement) connects an S/4HANA hub to multiple backend systems (ECC or other S/4HANA instances). The hub provides a unified view of contracts and analytics across all spokes, even when physical transactions occur in the spoke systems. Useful for global companies with multiple SAP instances.

8. EWM (EXTENDED WAREHOUSE MANAGEMENT)

EWM vs Classic WM

Aspect	Classic WM (ECC)	EWM (S/4HANA)
Integration	Tightly coupled with MM	Decoupled (separate WM layer)
Location	Within ECC	Embedded in S/4HANA or stand-alone
Features	Basic bin management	Advanced: Slotting, labor mgmt, yard mgmt
Document	Transfer Order	Warehouse Task (WT) / Warehouse Order (WO)
User	SAP GUI/TCODE	Fiori + RF Framework
Wave management	Not available	Available
Yard management	Not available	Available

EWM Architecture in S/4HANA

- * Embedded EWM: EWM runs within S/4HANA system (recommended for new implementations)
- * Decentralized EWM: Separate EWM system connected to S/4HANA via ALE/IDoc

EWM Key Terms

Term	Description
Warehouse Number	Unique identifier for a warehouse complex
Storage Type	Physical area within warehouse (e.g., Bulk, Rack, Floor)
Storage Section	Subdivision of storage type
Storage Bin	Smallest addressable unit (like a shelf slot)
HU (Handling Unit)	Packaged unit with barcode/label
Warehouse Task (WT)	Instruction to move goods between bins
Warehouse Order (WO)	Grouping of warehouse tasks for a worker
Physical Inventory (EWM)	Bin-level counting, distinct from MM inventory

GR Process in EWM

1. PO created in MM (S/4HANA core)
2. Inbound delivery created (via VL31N or automatically)
3. Inbound delivery transferred to EWM
4. EWM creates put-away warehouse task
5. RF/Fiori user confirms put-away to bin
6. Goods receipt confirmed in MM

Key Interview Questions

Q: What is the difference between a Warehouse Task and a Transfer Order in classic WM?

A: A Transfer Order (classic WM) is a simple instruction to move goods from source to destination bin. A Warehouse Task (EWM) is more granular - it represents a single physical movement step. Multiple warehouse tasks can be grouped into a Warehouse Order for efficient worker routing. EWM also supports two-step picking (staging area) and complex putaway strategies.

Q: How does EWM integrate with MM in S/4HANA?

A: When a goods movement relevant to a WM warehouse occurs in MM (e.g., GR against PO), the integrated EWM is automatically notified and creates corresponding warehouse tasks. The goods receipt is only finalized in MM after the EWM put-away is confirmed. This ensures inventory consistency between MM (storage location level) and EWM (bin level).

9. MIGRATION FROM ECC TO S/4HANA

Migration Approaches

Approach	Description	Best For
Greenfield (New Implementation)	Fresh S/4HANA installation, migrate only master data + open items	Large transformation, process redesign
Brownfield (System Conversion)	Convert existing ECC to S/4HANA, all history preserved	Minimal disruption, speed
Bluefield (Selective Data Transition)	Mix: some processes migrated, some run in parallel	Complex multi-entity scenarios
Shell Conversion	Convert system structure without business data, then migrate data	Clean data fresh start

Key Migration Checks for MM

1. Business Partner Migration: All vendors migrated to BP model
2. Material Ledger Activation: ML must be activated for all valuation areas
3. Custom Code Adaptation: ABAP code reading obsolete tables must be updated (use Custom Code Migration Tool)
4. S/4HANA Simplification List: SAP publishes a list of all functional changes - must be reviewed
5. Add-on compatibility: All installed add-ons must be S/4HANA-compatible
6. Fiori setup: Frontend server configuration, business catalogs/roles

SAP Readiness Check

Tool available on SAP Launchpad that analyzes existing ECC system:

- * Identifies simplification items affecting the system
- * Custom code that needs adaptation
- * Add-on compatibility issues
- * Provides effort estimates

Simplification Items (Key MM Examples)

Item	Change in S/4HANA
Material Number Length	Up to 40 characters (ECC: 18) - requires configuration
Aggregation Tables	Eliminated (e.g., MCHBH, MKOL) - custom code reading these must be rewritten
Purchase Info Record	New EINA/EINE structure in HANA - read via virtual data model
Goods Movement	MATDOC replaces MSEG/MKPF - new API for GR posting
Account Determination	KOBP/KOSP tables changed - custom account determination exits may need update

Key Interview Questions

Q: What is a Brownfield migration and what are its main risks?

A: Brownfield (system conversion) in-place converts an ECC system to S/4HANA, preserving all historical data and transactions. Risks include: data volume (HANA requires significant RAM), custom code requiring updates (checked via Custom Code Migration), business process disruptions if simplification items are not addressed, and the complexity of testing a live system conversion. Advantage: no data migration project, historical reporting continuity.

Q: What is the S/4HANA Simplification List?

A: SAP publishes a Simplification List for each S/4HANA release (available on SAP Help Portal). It documents every functional and technical change from ECC - what's removed, changed, or added. For MM, it details changes to tables, transaction codes, APIs, and business processes. It must be reviewed by both functional and technical teams before any migration project.

Q: How does custom code adaptation work for S/4HANA migration?

A: SAP provides the Custom Code Migration tool and ATC (ABAP Test Cockpit) with S/4HANA-specific checks. These tools scan customer ABAP code and flag: reading from obsolete tables, use of deprecated APIs, SQL statements on eliminated aggregate tables, and other incompatibilities. Flagged code must be rewritten to use the new APIs or virtual data models before migration.

10. S/4HANA EMBEDDED ANALYTICS

CDS Views (Core Data Services)

- * Virtual data models defined in ABAP
- * Replace aggregate/totals tables for reporting
- * Two types: Basic CDS (data foundation) and Analytical CDS (cube/dimension views)
- * Consumed by Fiori analytical apps, Analysis for Office, SAP Analytics Cloud

Key MM Analytical CDS Views

CDS View	Description
C_PurchaseOrderAnalysis	Purchase order analytics
C_PurchasingInfoRecordTP	PIR analytical view
I_MaterialStock	Real-time stock analytical view
C_GRIRAccountMaintenance	GR/IR analytics
C_SupplierInvoiceAnalysis	Invoice analytics

SAP Analytics Cloud (SAC) Integration

- * SAC connects to S/4HANA live via OData or import mode
- * Live connection: Real-time queries to HANA
- * Provides ML-based planning, predictive analytics, collaborative finance planning

Embedded BW (BW4HANA)

- * HANA-optimized data warehouse
- * Replaces standalone BW for most scenarios
- * Data sources: CDS views, extractors (still available)

Key Interview Questions

Q: What is the difference between a CDS view and an ABAP report for analytics?

A: A CDS view is a virtual data model defined in the database layer - it pushes computation down to HANA (code-to-data paradigm). Results are served directly from HANA memory without ABAP processing overhead. An ABAP report pulls data to the application server for processing. CDS views are dramatically faster for large datasets and are the S/4HANA recommended approach for analytical queries. They're also consumable by multiple frontend tools (Fiori, Analysis for Office, SAC).

11. SOURCING AND PROCUREMENT IN S/4HANA

New Purchasing Features

1. Central Contracts: Company-wide contracts accessible across plants/org units
2. Purchase Contract Cockpit: Single view of all contracts with compliance monitoring
3. Intelligent Sourcing: ML-recommended suppliers based on history
4. Procurement Analytics: Real-time spending analytics via Fiori

SRM (Supplier Relationship Management) Convergence

In S/4HANA, many SRM functions are embedded:

- * Self-service procurement (shopping cart) via S/4HANA
- * Central contracts
- * Supplier qualification integrated with Ariba Network

Ariba Integration

- * SAP Ariba handles external procurement network
- * Ariba Network connects buyers and suppliers globally
- * Integration scenarios: Purchase Requisition to Ariba, Invoice from Ariba to S/4HANA (via Ariba Network)
- * Transaction data flows via middleware (SAP Integration Suite)

Key Interview Questions

Q: How does S/4HANA integrate with SAP Ariba?

A: S/4HANA connects to Ariba via SAP Integration Suite (formerly Cloud Platform Integration). Procurement scenarios: PRs created in S/4HANA are transferred to Ariba for sourcing/approval, POs flow back to S/4HANA after approval, invoices from suppliers via Ariba Network are transferred to S/4HANA for posting. The integration uses standard APIs and can be configured via SAP's pre-built integration flows.

12. S/4HANA SPECIFIC TCODES AND APPS

Changed/New Transactions

S/4HANA	ECC Equivalent	Description
MD01N	MD01/MDBT	MRP Live planning run
F3000 (Fiori)	MIGO	Post Goods Receipt (Fiori)
BP	XK01/MK01	Create Business Partner
CKMLCP	CKMLCP (similar)	Actual Costing Run (enhanced)
SAL87000027	MMBE	Stock Overview (Fiori preferred)
FAGLL03H	FBL3N	G/L Line Items (HANA-optimized)

Deprecated/Changed in S/4HANA

ECC TCode	Status in S/4HANA	Reason
MB51	Available but use Fiori	Replaced by analytical Fiori app
MK01/MK02	Works via compatibility	Use BP instead
ME49	Works	Still available
MRKO	Works	Consignment settlement still valid
MMPV	Works	Period closing still required
CKMVFM	Works	ML revaluation

13. KEY S/4HANA INTERVIEW SCENARIOS

Scenario 1: ECC vendor master has 10,000 vendors - how to migrate to BP?

Answer: Use the FSCM_BP migration program or the Vendor Integration Workbench (transaction MDMGX). The program reads existing LFA1/LFB1/LFM1 records and creates corresponding Business Partners with the correct roles (FLVN00 for purchasing, FLVN01 for FI data). Exceptions (duplicate data, missing mandatory fields) must be resolved before migration. The CVI cockpit tracks migration status.

Scenario 2: MRP run produces different results in S/4HANA vs ECC

Answer: MRP Live uses the same core algorithm but differences can arise from: parallel processing sequence (results should be same mathematically but floating-point rounding may differ), firming zones calculated differently, planning horizon configuration, or HANA-side fixes for known ECC MRP issues (check simplification list). Run MD05N comparison reports and check MD04N for specific materials. Engage SAP if systematic differences found.

Scenario 3: User reports that stock in MMBE doesn't match accounting value

Answer: In S/4HANA with Material Ledger, stock quantity is managed in MM (MARD/MARC) and value in ML (MLBESTAND, ACDOCA). If there is a discrepancy, run CKMVFM (Material Ledger: Revaluation) or check for update errors (SM13). Also check if the period is properly closed (MMPV) and if the costing run (CKMLCP) was completed. CKMI1 (Post Closing) ensures ML values align with FI.

Scenario 4: Fiori app for GR posting shows different fields than MIGO

Answer: Fiori GR apps expose a simplified, role-based interface - they don't show all MIGO fields. For complex GR scenarios (split valuation, multiple account assignments, special stocks), MIGO via SAP GUI or SAP Business Client may still be needed. The Fiori app is designed for common 80% use cases. Custom Fiori extensions can add fields via app extensibility (key user tools in S/4HANA Cloud or AIF-based extensions in on-premise).

14. HANA STUDIO AND HANA ADMINISTRATION

SAP HANA Studio

- * Eclipse-based IDE for HANA development and administration
- * Key perspectives: Administration, Modeler, Debugger

Basic HANA SQL

```
-- Check column store table size
SELECT TABLENAME, MEMORYSIZEINTOTAL/1024/1024 AS SIZE_MB
FROM MCSTABLES
WHERE SCHEMA_NAME = 'SAPHANADB'
ORDER BY MEMORYSIZEIN_TOTAL DESC;

-- Check row count
SELECT COUNT(*) FROM "SAPHANADB"."EKKO";

-- Column store aggregation (fast)
SELECT LIFNR, SUM(NETWR) AS TOTAL
FROM "SAPHANADB"."EKKO"
GROUP BY LIFNR;
```

Key HANA Monitoring Views (M_ prefix = System Views)

View	Description
MCSTABLES	Column Store table info
MRSTABLES	Row Store table info
MSERVICEMEMORY	Memory usage by service
MLOADHISTORY_SERVICE	CPU/memory trends
MBACKUPCATALOG	Backup history
M_CONNECTIONS	Active DB connections

Key Interview Questions

Q: What is the difference between Column Store and Row Store in HANA, and how does it affect MM queries?

A: Column store organizes data by column - when querying specific columns across many rows (like summing PO values by vendor), only those columns are read, making it very fast. Row store organizes data by row - for single-record reads/updates (like looking up one PO header), row store is faster. In HANA, most business tables are column-stored. MM analytics (MB52 stock report, purchasing analysis) benefit enormously from the column store since they aggregate across millions of rows but only need a few columns.

15. SAP SUCCESSFACTORS AND CONCUR RELEVANCE (CLOUD ECOSYST

SAP Business Technology Platform (BTP)

- * Platform for building extensions and integrations
- * Key services: SAP Integration Suite, SAP Build (low-code), SAP Analytics Cloud, HANA Cloud
- * Replaces SAP Cloud Platform (SCP)

Integration with SAP Cloud Applications

Cloud App	Integration with S/4HANA MM
SAP Ariba	Procurement, sourcing, supplier management
SAP FieldGlass	Contingent workforce, service procurement
SAP Concur	Travel & expense (indirect procurement)
SAP IBP	Integrated Business Planning (advanced supply chain)
SAP Asset Manager	Asset management (PM-linked procurement)

Key Interview Questions

Q: How does SAP IBP differ from MRP Live for supply chain planning?

A: MRP Live handles operational short-term planning within S/4HANA (days to weeks horizon, material requirements). SAP IBP (Integrated Business Planning) is a strategic and tactical planning solution on BTP - covers demand sensing, supply planning, S&OP, and inventory optimization over longer horizons (months to years). IBP and S/4HANA are integrated: IBP's constrained supply plans are pushed to S/4HANA as planned orders or purchase requisitions.

16. CERTIFICATION RELEVANCE

SAP Certifications Relevant to MM/S4HANA

Certification	Code	Description
SAP S/4HANA Sourcing and Procurement	CTS4502022	MM in S/4HANA (primary)
SAP S/4HANA Supply Chain - Inventory Management	CTSCM5267	Inventory focus
SAP ERP Materials Management (ECC)	CTSCM5267	Legacy ECC cert
SAP Certified Associate - S/4HANA Cloud (MM)	Cloud-specific	For cloud implementations

Study Tips for S/4HANA MM Certification

- 1. Focus on Business Partner concept and setup
- 2. Understand Material Ledger mandatory activation
- 3. Know MRP Live configuration and differences
- 4. Practice Fiori app navigation and configuration
- 5. Know the Simplification List changes for MM
- 6. Understand the EWM vs WM differences
- 7. Practice HANA concepts (column store, in-memory)

*End of SAP HANA & S/4HANA Study Guide - Version 2025

Covers S/4HANA 2023/2024*